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The **Smart Founder** *Delegation Playbook*

*a framework for what to keep,
hand off, and automate*

SUMMIT VALOR

THE PROBLEM

Why founders struggle to delegate

Every founder knows they should delegate more. Almost none do it well. The reason isn't a lack of willpower — it's that delegation without a framework feels riskier than just doing it yourself.

Underneath that hesitation are a few familiar beliefs: it's faster to do it myself. No one will do it as well as I would. If I hand this off and it goes wrong, it's my name on it. Each of these is understandable. None of them scale.

The businesses that grow past the founder's personal capacity are the ones that replace those beliefs with a system — a clear, repeatable way to decide what only the founder should touch, what can be handed off now, and what should be automated entirely.

FOUR COMMON TRAPS

The perfectionist

Believes no one can do it to their standard, so nothing ever gets handed off.

The rescuer

Delegates the task but stays on call for every question, so nothing truly leaves their plate.

The vague delegator

Hands off outcomes without context, then is surprised when the result misses the mark.

The over-corrector

Delegates once, gets an imperfect result, and concludes delegation doesn't work.

THE FRAMEWORK

Three questions before you delegate anything

Before you hand off — or hold onto — any task, run it through these three questions in order.

01 Does this require me specifically?

Some tasks genuinely need the founder — vision-setting, key relationships, final decisions with real consequence. Most operational tasks don't, even if you've always done them.

02 Can this be made repeatable?

If a task can be documented into clear steps, it can be delegated. If it's still different every time, document the decision logic first, then delegate.

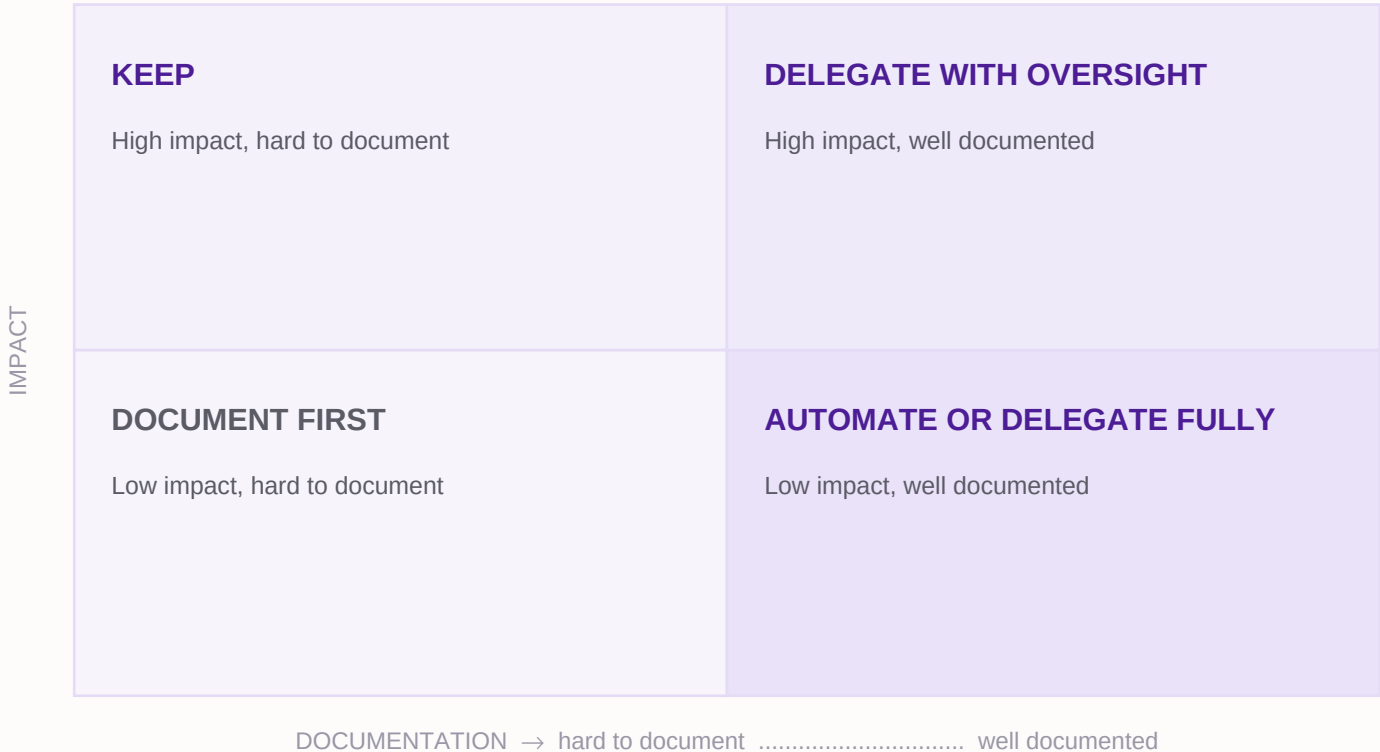
03 What's the real cost of an imperfect first attempt?

Most delegated tasks are lower-stakes than they feel. A slightly-off first draft is cheap. Treat early mistakes as the cost of training, not evidence delegation failed.

THE DELEGATION MATRIX

Plot every task on two axes

Score each recurring task on impact and how well-documented it is. The quadrant tells you what to do next.



PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE

Tasks to keep, delegate, and automate

TASKS TO KEEP

- Setting company vision and strategy
- Final hiring decisions for leadership roles
- Key client and partner relationships
- Decisions with irreversible consequences

TASKS TO DELEGATE

- Client onboarding and communication
- Content creation and scheduling
- Recurring reporting and data entry
- Project coordination and follow-up

TASKS TO AUTOMATE

- Invoicing and payment reminders
- Appointment scheduling and reminders
- Routine data syncing between tools
- Standard email sequences and follow-ups

These are starting points, not fixed rules — use the framework on the previous pages to sort your own recurring tasks into the right column.

WORKSHEET

Your delegation worksheet

Pick one task you're still holding onto. Work through the fields below before you hand it off.

TASK TO DELEGATE

WHY I'VE BEEN HOLDING ONTO IT

WHO COULD OWN THIS (NAME OR ROLE)

WHAT "DONE WELL" LOOKS LIKE

DOCUMENTATION OR CONTEXT THEY'LL NEED

CHECK-IN POINT (DATE AND FORMAT)

Delegation is a system. Let's build yours properly.

A worksheet gets you started. A Summit Operations Blueprint builds the full delegation structure your business needs to grow past you.

BOOK YOUR OPERATIONS BLUEPRINT

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